

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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BUILD A BRIDGE ***'Be a Bridge Builder'.***

These are my thoughts / reflections recently and the challenge that it is to every believer to be a person to passionately engage in bridge building in relation to the gap that can exists between ourselves, the local church and the world / community in which we live.

But is also relates to our personal relationships with others where there has been some breach in fellowship and the need for reconciliation, restoration, forgiveness etc.

I send them to you with the hope that our Heavenly Father through the Holy Spirit will somehow use them to inspire and motivate us all to be bridge builders.

BUILD A BRIDGE

- Using this analogy in relation to be building bridges of understanding, compassion, care which includes some active involvement.
- Bridges of tolerance, of acceptance, (accompanied with corresponding actions), of identification where there is evidence of a deliberate attempt to identify (i.e. to humble, to come down, to be willing to be stretched beyond our current comfort levels).

A BRIDGE – ITS PURPOSE!

The dictionary describes a bridge as:

- * A structure built to span physical **obstacles** such as a body of water, valley, or road, **for the purpose of providing passage over the obstacle.**
- * To connect or reduce the distance between something.
- ▶ **BRIDGES FORM CONNECTIONS BETWEEN ONE GROUP OF PEOPLE AND ANOTHER OR ONE SITUATION AND ANOTHER.**

The English dictionary states that:

- ▶ **AN OBSTACLE** could be a physical structure caused by a flood, tsunami, or earthquake etc.
- ▶ **BUT IT CAN ALSO BE OF A SPIRITUAL OR RELATIONAL NATURE CAUSED BY A BREACH IN HUMAN RELATIONSHIPS.**

// BUILD BRIDGES - INSTEAD OF WALLS

- * Walls divide, restrict and separates – produces gaps and distances between– BUT bridges connect, brings together, builds understanding and empathy, makes friends.

HUMAN OBSTACLES

- ▶ **WE NEED TO CREATE A BRIDGE THAT ENABLES US TO CROSS OVER AND CONNECT WITH THOSE PEOPLE WHO HAVE BUILT UP HUMAN OBSTACLES / WALLS BECAUSE OF HURT, OFFENCE, ABUSE, REJECTION, LONELINESS, SELF ISOLATION.**

BUILD A BRIDGE between who are different to us, those who are ethnically different with different ways of doing things

- * Of those persons that you find are difficult to associate or work with.
- * Those who have different social lives and sporting preferences etc.

BUILD A BRIDGE singular

Start with one bridge

- * Don't be intimidated with trying to build many bridges, start with one at a time.
- * After that you can then look at building another bridge

BUILD A BRIDGE by actively connecting

- * With those people in your immediate community and possibly further afield in another nation.
- * Seeking to build relationship and trust with the ultimate view of engaging and assisting poor and disadvantaged children, children's education program, children with AIDS, widows and the elderly – the abused domestic violence victims etc.
- * Start a widow's practical help program; share the vision with others and draw together volunteers to cook meals, cut lawns, gardening, small maintenance jobs etc.
- * Start a teaching English Language program for adults and / children.

BUILD A BRIDGE - personally

- * **Build a bridge in our own lives**; to span those things which keep us separated or distanced from other people and their lives.
- * **In our own lives** to bridge the gap of independence and wanting to do things our own way.
- * Of self-sufficiency and stoic holding in of our emotions trying always give the impression that we have it altogether.
- * **Addressing those things** by taking some simple steps in **expressing humility, softness and even tears towards God** and in our attitudes and behavior towards others.
- * Seeking to **breach the gap** that we have in wanting to be a loner and keep to ourselves. – always desiring 'our space'
- * Dealing with the gap of not wanting people to get too close to us for fear of them seeing the weaknesses of our lives.
- * Build a bridge to fill those gaps of poor behavioral patterns in relation to offences, hurts, and adverse events that our lives are exposed to.

BUILD A BRIDGE - with spouse & children

- * **Bridges of understanding and intimacy with your spouse, children and relatives (on both sides)**
- * Making sure that you spend time with spouse and children to counteract those gaps that cunningly appear without warning all because of our busyness with ministry and other family matters.
- * Being more considerate and understanding with each other taking time out to and talking and explaining life events to our children.
- * Take some active and deliberate steps to develop and increase empathy with what your spouses might be facing because of difficulties and demands from extended family.

BUILD A BRIDGE – through forgiveness

- * Take some small personal steps towards forgiving someone.

Steps like:

- * Start desiring / **wanting** to forgive.
- * **Start praying** FOR OURSELVES for an attitude (spirit of forgiveness) to come into our heart.
- * **START PRAYING** for that person or persons not that they will change but that you will change in respect to forgiving them without them saying sorry or admitting fault on their part.
- * **Note:** it is much harder to pray for change in our own lives while at the same time struggling with the offense or hurt done to us by some person or persons. **BUT TAKE THE INITIATIVE** and ask God to help us to take some small steps to establish connection with them.
- * **Important advice:** Forgiving even those persons who have died or moved on to locations unknown to us, who have caused us hurt, harm or injury is sometimes necessary for us to experience a greater sense of freedom from the memory of the past resulting in a liberty in fellowship with one another and with the Lord.

TRULY WE ARE BLESSED TO HAVE THE ABILITY AND THE OPPORTUNITY TO BE BRIDGE BUILDERS FOR JESUS.

Amen – Ps Barry